

Lesson Unpacking Task Card

Module 2/ Unit 2 / Lesson: 7 - Write an Informative Essay - Analyze a Model

Date: February 2nd, 2026

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Lesson Unpacking

Learning Targets

- I can find the gist of a model essay.
- I can analyze a model essay to generate criteria of an effective informative essay on my selected research case study. (W.8.2, W.8.4)

Success Criteria

- ☐ Use the Painted Essay Template to color code each part of the Model Informative Essay
- ☐ Find the Gist of a model paragraph
- ☐ Analyze the Model Essay [Via Course Mojo](#) - Respond to the Target Questions
- ☐ Review the Informative Writing Checklist

Ongoing Assessment

- Opening A: Entrance Ticket: Unit 2, Lesson 7
- Closing and Assessment A: Informative Writing: "GMOs" checklist (RI.8.1, W.8.2)

Focus Standards

RI.8.1

Cite the textual evidence that most strongly supports an analysis of what the text says explicitly as well as inferences drawn from the text.

W.8.2

Write informative/explanatory texts to examine a topic and convey ideas, concepts, and information through the selection, organization, and analysis of relevant content.

W.8.

Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and

	style are appropriate to task, purpose, and audience.	
Teaching Agenda	<u>Agenda</u> • Opening ◦ Engage the Learner (5 minutes) • Work Time ◦ A. Read for Gist: Model Essay: "GMOs" (10 minutes) ◦ B. Analyze a Model Essay - Course Mojo (15 minutes) • Closing and Assessment ◦ Review Criteria for Informative Essay (5 minutes) • Homework ◦ Independent Research Reading ◦ Pre-read for Gist - CSA's If appropriate, note any ICT models that apply: Station Teaching, Parallel Teaching, Alternative	
Lesson Alignment	What will students learn and do in this lesson that is aligned with the Module Guiding C • W.8.2 – Opening A: Students use the Painted Essay® structure to analyze a model in essay and add to their understanding of the criteria of an effective informative essay • RI.8.1 – Work Time B: Students cite textual evidence as they analyze the structure o essay. • W.8.4 – Work Time B: Students analyze the organization and development of a mod reflecting on how each paragraph relates to the author's purpose. • W.8.2 – Closing and Assessment A: Students use a model informative essay and the Writing: "GMOs" checklist to generate specific criteria for their own essays. What knowledge and skills assessed on the next Unit Assessment are connected to this • For the end of unit assessment, students will use the information from th and subsequent Informative essay to create a lesson plan to then teach a students.	
Lesson	What have students already learned?	

Sequence	- Students have worked with the Painted Essay® structure in Module 1. In this lesson, students will use the same structure and examine how it applies to this essay prompt, looking closely at how the author uses evidence effectively to analyze the ways GMOs increase or decrease our access to healthy food. - In previous lessons, students worked in pairs to conduct research on the influence of GMOs on access to healthy food. What comes next? - In the next lesson, students will complete a Language Dive on focus statements and introductions for their essays. - In Lessons 8 and 9, students will refer back to and analyze parts of the model essays and their own informative essays on their selected case studies. They will use their plan to revise their essays in Lessons 10 and 11. Afterward, students will use the Desktop Teacher to present the research findings they have written about.		
Lesson Plan (to guide instruction)			
Record and internalize questions, anchor charts, protocols, tasks (e.g. graphic organizers) and vocabulary that will support students in meeting Learning Targets:			
Opening 5 mins	Teacher actions/questions* - Teacher(s) directs students to complete the entrance ticket “What is the Painted Essay® structure, and how can it support the writing process?” (The Painted Essay® is a structure that uses color to help us understand the content of each part of the essay and how the different parts connect.) - Teacher instructs students to TURN AND TALK to share their responses with a partner A/B Teacher uses Equity sticks during sharing discussion - Teacher reviews the learning targets and success criteria for the lesson	Student work - Students complete entrance ticket: “What is the Painted Essay® structure, and how can it support the writing process?” ☐ Students TURN AND TALK to share their Answer to Entrance ticket (Students edit their responses if applicable) - Students share responses with the class - Answers will differ Vocabulary NONE (A) Key - (A) Academic Vocabulary Gist	Teacher the q Grou Faith Rhym Vasa Jonah Nath Leyla Mela Kylie

Record and internalize **questions, anchor charts, protocols, and tasks** (e.g. graphic organizers) that will support students in meeting Learning Targets:

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Work Time

A.
10 mins

Read for Gist: Model Essay: "GMOs" (10 minutes)

- Review learning targets of the lesson:
 - **"I can find the gist of the model essay".**
- Teacher Introduces students to their essay prompt: How does "x" influence our access to healthy food?
- Teacher explains that "x" represents different topics that influence access to healthy foods that they will be researching.
- Teacher tells students that in this model essay, we will examine GMOs, so the specific question we will be examining in the model essay is: "How do GMOs influence our access to healthy food?"
- Teacher distributes and displays the **Model Essay: "GMOs."**
- Teacher instructs students to review the essay for gist and follow the painted essay structure model to color code each part of the Informative essay
- Teacher asks the following questions:
 - **"What is this model about?"** (GMOs and the ways in which they increase and/or decrease our access to healthy foods)
- **Students reflect on their progress toward the learning targets.**

Teacher Materials

- Equity sticks
- Work to Become Effective Learners Anchor Chart — from 8.1.2.4
- Paint an Essay Lesson Plan — from 8.1.3.6
- Entrance Ticket: Unit 2, Lesson 7

Student work

Think-Pair-Share

- Students use The Painted Essay Model to color code the model essay
- Students discuss the Gist of the model essay

Student Materials

- Entrance Ticket: Unit 2, Lesson 7
- Homework: Preread for Gist: "CSAs" (see Homework Resources)
- Informative Writing Checklist
- Model Essay: "GMOs"
- Access to Healthy Food: Independent Research Note-Catcher — from 8.2.2.4
- Painted Essay® Template — from 8.1.3.6
- Homework: Preread for Gist: "GMOs" — from 8.2.2.6
- Model Essay: "CSAs" — from 8.2.2.8
- Researcher's Toolbox — from 8.2.2.1
- Homework:
- Device
- Colored pencils (red, yellow, blue, green, one of each per student)
- Independent Reading Journal
- Dictionary
- Vocabulary Log

	• <i>Homework: Preread for Gist: “CSAs”</i> • <i>Informative Writing Checklist</i> • <i>Model Essay: “GMOs”</i> • <i>Homework: Preread for Gist: “GMOs” (for reference) – from 8.2.2.6</i> • <i>Device with projector (see Technology and Multimedia)</i>		
Work Time B 15 mins	B. Analyze a Model Essay - (15 mins) ■ Review the learning target relevant to the work to be completed in this section of the lesson: • <i>“I can analyze a model to generate criteria of an effective informative essay on my selected research case study.”</i> ☐ Teacher organize students into table groups: 6 heterogeneous groups ☐ Teacher ask students to log into Course Mojo and Think-Pair-Share to answer each of the six driving questions’ ☐ Teacher circulate to monitor/support students who are struggling. ☐ After students answer the driving questions teacher reviews the misconceptions ☐ Teacher uses EQUITY STICKS to have students share responses ☐ Teacher instructs students to answer the TARGET QUESTIONS INDEPENDENTLY. - 5 mins	Students work • Think-Pair-Share • Markers to highlight text • Students work with their partners to answer the six driving questions • <i>Highlight the sentences in the first paragraph that give background information (context) about the different factors that affect access to healthy food. Why is it helpful to include this context at the beginning of the essay?</i> • <i>Highlight the focus statement in the first paragraph. Reread the focus statement. What will this essay be about?</i> • <i>Highlight one sentence that shows an increase in access to healthy food caused by GMOs. Then, highlight one sentence that shows a decrease in access to healthy food or a concern about GMOs. How does the writer organize the information about increases and decreases in access to healthy food in this essay?</i> • <i>What does the author use to support the claims about how GMOs affect access to healthy food?</i> • <i>Highlight the sentence in the conclusion that restates the focus</i>	

	☐ Teacher uses EQUITY STICKS to have students share responses ☐ Students reflect on their progress toward the learning target.	<i>of the essay. Why is it important for the author to restate the focus in the conclusion?</i> • <i>What is the purpose of the conclusion in this essay?</i> • Students <u>independently</u> answer the TARGET QUESTIONS • What are two techniques (methods or ways) the author uses to effectively inform readers about how GMOs influence access to healthy food? • Based on your analysis of this model essay, what are 3-4 elements you should include when writing your own informative essay about how your research topic influences access to healthy food?	
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How will we know if students met the Learning Target(s)?

[Scaffolding needed](#)

Closing 5 mins	<u>Review Criteria for Informative Essay - (5 minutes)</u> Teacher actions/questions* ■ <i>Teacher reviews the learning target relevant to the work to be</i>	<u>Student work</u> THINK-PAIR-SHARE • “Where do you see evidence of W.8.2a: ‘I provide a clear focus and maintain the focus consistently throughout the piece.’?” <i>the author provides a clearly stated focus statement that</i>	Con Con Pers (An pres "dile weig and He i that
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	completed in this section of the lesson: ○ <i>“I can analyze a model essay to determine criteria for an informative essay on my selected research case study.”</i> ■ Teacher conducts a THINK-PAIR-SHARE Teacher asks three questions ■ “Where do you see evidence of W.8.2a: ‘I provide a clear focus and maintain the focus consistently throughout the piece.’?” ■ “How will using this model essay and the Informative Writing: ‘GMOs’ Checklist support the upcoming writing tasks?” ■ “Review the Work to Become Effective Learners Anchor Chart , and give examples of ways in which you showed perseverance or collaboration in today’s partner work.” ■ TEACHER USES EQUITY STICKS to encourage students to share	mentions two points, one regarding a way his/her research case study increases access to healthy food, and one regarding a way his/her research case study decreases access to healthy food. Each Proof Paragraph is based on one of these main points. ● Students record a response on row 2 of their Informative Writing checklist. THINK-PAIR-SHARE ● “How might a checklist like this support an author in writing clearly about the increases and decreases in access to healthy food in the Model Essay: ‘GMOs’ ?” (using the Informative Writing: “GMOs” Checklist could help the author to remember to provide a clear focus supported with evidence.) ● “How will using this model essay and the Informative Writing: ‘GMOs’ Checklist support the upcoming writing tasks?” ■ Students reflect on their progress toward the learning target.	are incre and price mak acco lowe fami
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Homework

A. Preread a Model Essay for Gist

- Students complete **Homework: Preread for Gist: “CSAs”** to answer selected and constructed response questions about Model Essay: “CSAs.”

B. Complete the Informative Writing Checklist with evidence from the model essay from today’s lesson.

Model Essay: “GMOs”

RI.8.1, W.8.2, W.8.4, W.8.9, L.8.6

(Example for Teacher Reference)

Prompt: How do GMOs influence our access to healthy food?

Access to healthy food is a basic human need. It can be complicated. In America today, many factors influence our access to healthy food. Do we have enough money to buy healthy food? Is healthy food available where we live? Can we find food that is grown in good soil? Can we find food that is free of chemicals that might cause harm? Can our soil and water contribute to growing healthy food? Can we find healthy food from healthy animals? All of these are factors we consider when we think about access to healthy food. Today, some foods are the result of genetic changes that have been made by scientists. These are known as GMOs, or genetically modified organisms. GMOs are made by splicing new genes from one plant into another. This changes the plant in some way. For example, a plant scientist might want to find a way to grow strawberries that are resistant to frost. This would allow the growing season to last longer. She might take the “frost gene” from parsley (which can take a frost) and splice it into strawberry plants. The new strawberry plants would be a form of GMO (Erdosh and Lusted, 17). GMOs influence our access to healthy food. In many ways, GMOs seem to improve access to healthy foods. In other ways, the safety and benefit of GMOs are still being questioned.

There are many cases in which GMOs seem to improve Americans’ access to healthy foods. First, GMO corn has increased the amount of corn available. A review of 6,000 studies between 1996 and 2016 showed that GMOs had increased production of corn by up to 25 percent (Dovey, 2018). This is important because much of the food supply depends on many animals eating corn. Also, corn is used in many other food products. This means that increasing the amount of corn means

more people have dependable access to food. Some people have been worried that there is a nutritional difference between GMO and non-GMO food. However, there seems to be no difference. In fact, GMO canola oil has fewer trans fats than regular canola oil (bestfoods.org). Canola oil is used to make many other foods. This means that GMOs may actually increase people's access to healthy food. Finally, the new genes in some corn make it harder for harmful insects to survive. This means that farmers who grow the GMO corn have been able to use fewer pesticides (Brody, 2018). In the long run, GMOs can increase people's access to healthy food because there is more food and fewer pesticides in the soil, the water, and the food itself.

Although GMOs seem to improve access to healthy food, questions about the safety of using GMOs still remain. Some of these questions have to do with long-term effects on consumers' health. For example, the *New York Times* reported in 2018 about a GMO called EnlistDuo. It is supposed to make crop plants more resistant to weed-killing chemicals. However, it has been found to increase the prevalence of a cancer called non-Hodgkin's lymphoma (Brody, 2018). Others point out that GMOs have not been in use long enough for us to be certain they are safe (Brody, 2018). If GMOs may make people sick, they are not improving their access to healthy food. Another question is about the health of the soil that GMO crops are growing in. Some studies show that it is true that pesticide use has fallen by a third with GMOs. This certainly makes for healthier soil. However, the same studies show that herbicide use (weed killers) has increased by 21 percent with GMO crops (Hakim, 2016). This raises the question about whether GMOs are really good for the soil and the supply of healthy food. Finally, the fact that GMOs have improved corn yields may not be an entirely helpful impact. As Michael Pollan points out in *The Omnivore's Dilemma*, cattle in feedlots are fed corn because it fattens them quickly. However, corn is not their natural food. He explains, "their corn-based diet . . . makes them ill" (Pollan, 70). As a result, the cattle have to be given antibiotics, which causes other problems. As with herbicides, this raises the question about whether increasing the corn supply with GMOs has improved access to healthy meat, or made it worse. The Non-GMO Project explains that "in the absence of credible independent long-term feeding studies, the safety of GMOs is unknown. Increasingly, citizens are taking matters into their own hands and choosing to opt out of the GMO experiment." Over time, it is possible that GMOs may prove to decrease people's access to healthy food because they may be dangerous to consume or may have a negative impact on our food industry.

W.8.2c: Well-chosen transitions create connections and clarify relationships between ideas and concepts.

RI.8.1, W.8.9: Effectively use textual evidence to support various elaborative claims. Comprehensive evidence is integrated, relevant, specific and supports the points being made.

Overall, there are indications that GMOs improve people's access to healthy food. At the same time, many questions and potential harms to health remain. It seems sensible to very closely study and monitor the effects of GMOs on human health, animal health, and soil and water. Having reliable access to healthy food, both short and long term, is too important to leave to chance.

W.8.2f: Conclusion or explanation, offers insights/reflection, restates focus statement.

W.8.2a: Uses appropriate structure; well-organized; uses formatting to enhance comprehension, organization, complexity, and make important connections and distinctions.

Informative Writing: "GMOs" Checklist

Name:

Date:

Standard	Characteristics of Effective Informative Writing	Characteristics of This Informative Writing Piece	Date Completed
RI.8.1, W.8.9	My focus shows that I clearly understand the topic or text and is well supported with evidence from reliable sources.		
W.8.2a	I provide a clear focus and maintain the focus consistently throughout the piece.		
W.8.2a	I introduce the topic clearly, giving readers a preview of the piece.		
W.8.2f	I have a conclusion that supports the information presented.		
W.8.2a	I use strategies such as definition, classification, comparison/contrast, and cause/effect to organize information.		

Standard	Characteristics of Effective Informative Writing	Characteristics of This Informative Writing Piece	Date Completed
W.8.2c	I use a variety of appropriate transitions to show how ideas and information connect.		
W.8.2b	I use relevant facts, definitions, details, quotations, and examples to explain my thinking.		
W.8.2a	I use formatting, illustrations, and multimedia to help the reader understand information and ideas.	Not applicable	
W.8.2d, L.8.6	I use precise language and domain-specific vocabulary.		
W.8.4 (partial), W.8.2e	I use a formal style.		

Standard	Characteristics of Effective Informative Writing	Characteristics of This Informative Writing Piece	Date Completed
L.8.1	My words and sentences follow the rules of writing.		
L.8.2	My spelling, capitalization, and punctuation are correct.		

Language Dive Planner

Language Dive Planner

Purpose: Teachers will identify the meaning and purpose of a compelling sentence from a complex text, and plan for how students will build language, literacy skills, and habits of mind. [45 minutes - for those new to Language Dives]

Read the Rationale in the Guide. Why are students closely reading this sentence? [10 min]

What content knowledge and vocabulary about the topic will students build in this language dive?

What will students learn about the use of language?

Sentence: [5 min]

Which part of the sentence is the focus structure?

Process	Read the teacher notes in the guide. Select priority questions.
Deconstruct [10 min] <i>Discuss the meaning and purpose of each chunk of the sentence.</i>	
Reconstruct [10 min] <i>Students scramble and reconstruct the sentence, chunk by chunk like a puzzle, to create the full sentence and any possible variations, revisiting the meaning and purpose.</i>	
Practice [10 min] <i>Students practice using the prioritized language structures as they say and write their own sentences in a new context.</i>	

Unpacking Facilitation (V1)

Overview: This facilitation guide is meant to be used in collaboration with a teacher or teachers who need support to deepen their understanding of the lesson planning and delivery process within the EL Education curriculum. It is not intended to be used as a lesson planning template.

This template provides **light** support. It is recommended to be used with teachers who are newest to the curriculum or who continue to struggle with the planning process.

Lesson Overview		
Learning Targets:	Lesson Text(s):	Lesson Task(s):
On-Going Assessment		
<i>How are the students being assessed? (List the relevant materials: checklists, note-catchers, exit tickets etc.)</i>		
Teaching Notes		
<i>Describe the key purposes for the texts and tasks. How does the lesson build on previous lessons? How does this lesson build toward future lessons?</i>		
Protocols and Anchors Charts		
List the protocols.	List the anchor charts	
Opening Activity		
Knowledge and Skills <i>How do the learning targets frame what the students will learn and practice in the lesson?</i>	Questions <i>How do the questions set the stage for the lesson?</i>	Routines <i>What routines and/or protocols are used?</i>
Work Time A		

Knowledge and Skills <i>What are students learning? What skills are they practicing?</i>	Questions <i>What questions are students grappling with?</i>	Routines <i>What routines and/or protocols are used?</i>
Work Time B		
Knowledge and Skills <i>What are students learning? What skills are they practicing?</i>	Questions <i>What questions are students grappling with?</i>	Routines <i>What routines and/or protocols are used?</i>
Work Time C		
Knowledge and Skills <i>What are students learning? What skills are they practicing?</i>	Questions <i>What questions are students grappling with?</i>	Routines <i>What routines and/or protocols are used?</i>
Closing		
Knowledge and Skills <i>How are students assessing their learning?</i>	Routines <i>What routines and/or protocols are used?</i>	

Unpacking Facilitation (V2)

Overview: This facilitation guide is meant to be used in collaboration with a teacher or teachers who need support to deepen their understanding of the lesson planning and delivery process within the EL Education curriculum. It is not intended to be used as a lesson planning template.

This template provides **medium** support. It is recommended to be used with teachers who have some experience with the planning process and are ready to deepen their thinking.

Lesson Title:		
Learning Target(s): <i>How will you unpack the learning targets with students?</i>	Tasks: <i>What will the students do in the lesson?</i>	Text(s)
Work Time A: <i>Describe what the students and teachers will be doing in this part of the lesson. (What questions guide the learning?)</i>		
Student Engagement: <i>What protocols and resources are used? (Total participation techniques, conversation cues, etc.)</i>	Student Independence: <i>What resources support grappling with a task and/or text? (Anchor chart, graphic organizer, etc.)</i>	Assessment: <i>How will you assess progress? (Checklist, rubric, etc.)</i>
Support: <i>Describe the supports added to meet student needs.</i>		Extensions: <i>Describe the opportunities to extend learning.</i>

Work Time B: <i>Describe what the students and teachers will be doing in this part of the lesson. (What questions guide the learning?)</i>		
Student Engagement: <i>What protocols and resources are used? (Total participation techniques, conversation cues, etc.)</i>	Student Independence: <i>What resources support grappling with a task and/or text? (Anchor chart, graphic organizer, etc.)</i>	Assessment: <i>How will you assess progress? (Checklist, rubric, etc.)</i>

		v w i l l t h e t e a c h e r a n d s t u d e n t s a s s e s s m e n t s p r o g r e s s ? (C h e c k l i s t , a n c
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		h o r o h a r t , e t c .)
Support: <i>Describe the supports added to meet student needs.</i>		Extensions: <i>Describe the opportunities to extend student learning.</i>

Work Time C: <i>Describe what the students and teachers will be doing in this part of the lesson. (What questions guide the learning?)</i>		
Student Engagement: <i>What protocols and resources are used? (Total participation techniques, conversation cues, etc.)</i>	Student Independence: <i>What resources support grappling with a task and/or text? (Anchor chart, graphic organizer, etc.)</i>	A s s e s s m e n t : h o w w i l l t h e t e a c h e r a

		n o s t u d e n t s a s s e s s m e n t s r e s u l t s (C O H e r e K i l i s t . a n d r e s u l t a t t e n t i o n)
Support: <i>Describe the supports added to meet student needs.</i>		Extensions: <i>Describe the</i>

	<i>opportunities to extend student learning.</i>
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Closing: <i>Describe what the students and teachers will be doing in this part of the lesson. (What questions synthesize or a</i>	
Assessment: <i>How will the teacher and students assess progress? (Checklist, anchor chart, etc.)</i>	Student Engagement: <i>What protocols participation techniques, conversation c</i>
Support: <i>Describe the supports added to meet student needs.</i>	Extensions: <i>Describe the opportunities</i>

Unpacking Facilitation (V3)

Overview: This facilitation guide is meant to be used in collaboration with a teacher or teachers who need support to deepen their understanding of the lesson planning and delivery process within the EL Education curriculum. It is not intended to be used as a lesson planning template.

This template provides **heavy** support. It is recommended to be used with teachers who are the most experienced with the planning process and has been designed to further deepen their understanding of the curriculum.

What led up to this lesson? • What knowledge and skills from the previous lesson(s) are students building on? • How does this lesson connect to the guiding questions and big ideas of this module/IB unit? <i>What independent practice did the students complete in preparation for this lesson?</i> Where is this lesson leading? • How will the knowledge and skills in this lesson support the learning in the next lesson(s)? • How does it lead to the assessment and/or performance task?		
Standards: (list the standards)		
Learning Targets: (list the lesson learning targets)		Elaborate on the Learning Targets. • <i>How might you put the learning targets into practice?</i> • <i>Have these learning targets been used in a previous lesson or are they new?</i> • <i>Do they build on/extend previous learning?</i>
Protocols • <i>What will you need to consider when preparing to use the protocols?</i>	Supporting Materials (review the list of support materials for the teacher, the students in general and the students who will need support) • <i>What preparation of materials is required for this lesson?</i>	Anchor Charts (review the list of anchor charts that are referred to in the lesson) • <i>Are any of the anchor charts being added to the lesson?</i> • <i>What preparation is required for the anchor charts?</i>

Opening (what is the gist of this section) • <i>What is the purpose(s) of this section of the lesson?</i> • <i>How does this section help build student interest?</i> • <i>What questions help to drive the learning?</i> • <i>How does this section prepare students to engage in the work time?</i>
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What challenges might students face in this section? Which students might face challenges? Why?	What opportunities exist to extend student thinking? Which students might be ready to be challenged? How can the rigor be increased?
Work Time (what is the gist of this section) <i>What skills and knowledge are the students practicing?</i> <i>What questions help to drive the learning?</i> <i>What opportunities exist to assess their learning (students and teachers)?</i>	
What challenges might students face in this section? Which students might face challenges? Why?	What opportunities exist to extend student thinking? Which students might be ready to be challenged? How can the rigor be increased?
Closing (what is the gist of this section) <i>How will students share their learning?</i> <i>What opportunities exist for students to assess their learning?</i> <i>What opportunities exist for the teacher to assess student learning?</i> <i>What independent practice is provided?</i>	
What challenges might students face in this section/with the independent practice? Which students might face challenges? Why?	What opportunities exist to extend student thinking/with independent practice? Which students might be ready to be challenged? How can the rigor be increased?